

STAGE TEN • RELATIONSHIPS & CONNECTIONS

FIRSTS

ICEBREAKERS / OPENERS

Short, stage-themed warm-ups tied to what each session actually covers

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Icebreakers / Openers

Stage Ten • Relationships & Connections

PURPOSE

Stage Ten runs across three sessions — Friendships & Peer Connections, Project Partners & Teamwork, and Mentorship & Professional Connections — each gets one icebreaker below, built directly from that session's actual content.

Because this stage is inherently about real relationships, these openers lean on genuine (if low-stakes) personal sharing rather than purely playful warm-ups. Each one surfaces, in the group's own words and stories, the exact distinction or pattern the session's formal FIRSTS are about to name explicitly.

Each includes the instructions to read to the group, a time estimate, and a short note on why it's specifically the right opener for what comes next.

Three Openers, One Per Session

SESSION 1

The Friendship Origin Story

TIME: 10 min

1. In pairs, each person has 90 seconds to tell the story of how they met their oldest or closest friend — not who the friend is, but the actual moment of meeting.
2. Partner listens for one thing: was the friendship built on proximity (same class, same team) or on something more deliberate?
3. Quick full-group show of hands: how many origin stories started as pure proximity that later became genuine investment?

WHY THIS WORKS

This surfaces, before any formal teaching, the exact distinction FIRST N1 is built on — that proximity is a starting point, not the same thing as genuine friendship.

SESSION 2

The Group Project Hall of Fame (and Shame)

TIME: 8 min

1. Ask the group: “think of the best group project or team experience you've ever had — what made it work?” Quick round-robin, one word or phrase each.
2. Now ask the opposite: “think of the worst one — what made it fail?” Same format.
3. Facilitator collects both lists visibly (whiteboard or shared doc) without commentary yet.

WHY THIS WORKS

This produces, in the group's own words, most of the real content this session will formally cover — delegation, alignment, feedback, accountability — which makes the upcoming FIRSTS feel like solutions to problems the group just named themselves.

SESSION 3

Two-Degree Connection

TIME: 8 min

1. Ask each participant to name one person they know, personally or through someone else, who works in a field or role they find interesting.
2. In pairs, share how you actually know that connection — direct, or through someone else?
3. Quick full-group tally: how many of those connections came through someone else, not directly?

WHY THIS WORKS

This makes visible, before any formal teaching, how much of a real professional network already

runs through indirect connections — exactly the logic behind FIRST N26 (Industry Contact Made) and the peer-circle model in N25.